

Mitchell Stern

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EDUCATION

The College of Wooster, Wooster, Ohio, Bachelor of Arts
Major: Biology **GPA:** 3.1

Graduation date – May 2014

Independent Study: One-year study (2013-2014) at the College of Wooster on mate preference between hybridizing populations of the northern ravine salamander and the red-backed salamander. The study involved genotyping and conducting behavioral trials on salamanders, and resulted in a 60-page experimental report

Honors: Awarded APEX fellowship (2013); research on multi-locus molecular evidence for widespread hybridization between the northern ravine salamander and the red-backed salamander presented by Dr. Richard Lehtinen at the 6th Conference on the Biology of Plethodontid Salamanders, Tulsa, Oklahoma, May 18th-20th, 2014; Allen Scholar

Study Abroad: University of York, York, England,

Fall 2012

- Courses included Biotechnology, Immunology, Neuroscience, Population Genetics, and Environmental Interactions

RELATED EXPERIENCE

Mente Argentina, Buenos Aires, Argentina

Summer 2013

- Worked under Dr. Maria Mercedes at Hospital de Clínicas and provided bedside care to children, ages five through 18, in the infirmary ward. Bedside care involved checking patient health statuses, bringing fresh towels, playing board games, and talking with the children and their parents. Doctors and patients spoke solely Spanish
- Completed advanced Spanish courses at the International Bureau of Language School in Buenos Aires
- Presented program experience as part of APEX fellowship during International Education Week in Wooster

Volunteer Research Assistant, RUSH University Medical Center, Chicago, Illinois

Summers 2011 and 2012

- Assisted Dr. Sue Mikolaitis and research on breast cancer microbiota, and DNA methylation for detection and monitoring of colorectal cancer
- Created Excel spread for the organization and daily retrieval of patient samples for ongoing research
- Taught new volunteers to operate the samples database, Freezerworks, and organize patient information
- Learned how to effectively separate plasma from blood in the lab; and how blood and stool are collected from patients, stored, and utilized in research through various tests (creatinine levels being the biggest focus)

Shadowing: Dr. Carline Quander, Gastroenterologist at RUSH University Medical Center (June 2011); Dr. Cheryl Harth, Oncologist at the Texas Oncology Methodist Dallas Cancer Center (March 2012); Dr. Eric Barnes, Orthodontist in Chicago (June 2012); Dr. Leonard Robinson, General Medicine in Chicago (June 2012); Dr. Marie Wilson-Marshall, Pediatrician in Chicago (July 2012); Dr. Maria Mercedes, neurosurgeon and volunteer coordinator at Hospital de Clínicas in Buenos Aires, Argentina (June-July 2013); Dr. Karen Kamelman, rheumatologist at Hospital de Clínicas in Buenos Aires, Argentina (June-July 2013)

ACTIVITIES

Proyecto Latino, College of Wooster, Wooster, Ohio

2010-2012

- Participate in student-run Latin awareness group

English as a Second Language (ESL) Volunteer, Orrville, Ohio

Fall 2010

- Taught English to native-Spanish speakers ranging from 12 to 40 years old once a week

Vital Bridges Volunteer, Food pantry to AIDS patients, Chicago, Illinois

2008-2009

- Processed paperwork for food orders, bagged and tracked food inventory, and trained new volunteers

SKILLS

- Laboratory work, including Polymerase Chain Reaction (PCR), Gel Electrophoresis, Enzyme-Linked Immunosorbent Assay (ELISA), Thin Layer Chromatography (TLC), and Infrared Spectroscopy (IR)
- Proficient in Spanish at advanced level
- Proficient with Microsoft, Excel, PowerPoint, SPSS Statistics, and Freezerworks
- Strong verbal and written communication acquired from writing intensive courses and presentations